

SPORTS WORLD

By Harold U. Ribalow

Greatest Quarterback

Sid Luckman was a football star with the Chicago Bears for twelve years and was Columbia University's top player for three years before that. He quit a long time ago, but he still makes newspaper columns, especially those written by men who remember his exploits and insist he was the best of a brilliant lot of quarterbacks in his time.

In a recent column on Luckman, Jimmy Cannon wrote that "men are still flattered to be in his company." And that he was "the greatest quarterback I've ever seen." He also informed his readers that Luckman is now in business, serving as vice-president of Cellucraft and that he has an 18-year-old son who is himself quite a good football player—but not as his dad, who was one of the very best.

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French Lightweight

There is another Jewish fighter from French North Africa who may make the grade as a champion. His name is Sauveur Beenamou, who lost recently to Dave Charnley, the British champion. Beenamou is strongly muscled but doesn't seem to hit very hard. "He is, however, tough and hard to

discourage. Charnley is a south-paw and the left-handed style upset the Jewish lad. Give him a bit more experience, and it is possible he will follow in the footsteps, or glove-marks, of Alphonse Halimi who was an excellent fighter at his peak.

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A Word on Tennis

Angela Buxton Silk, who made her mark as Angela Buxton in British tennis, recently wrote an article for the Jewish Chronicle of London in which she bewailed the decline of Jewish interest in tennis. Her conclusion is that there aren't enough junior players working at it to make good. It is a pleasant sport, she remarks, and so it should be more popular than it is. But it isn't and that's that. The same is true in the United States. And Angela, like Americans, points to the Australians, to whom the game is of major importance. True enough. But what can you do about it?

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Andy Cohen

Now that Andy Cohen, the old Jewish ballplayer of the 1920's, is a coach with the Philadelphia Phillies, the columnists are catching up with him and interviewing him about his past. The stories are pleasant enough and they recall how exciting it was for the Jewish sports fans to root for one of their own in the Era of Wonderful Nonsense. Cohen says today that "I've had a long wait to get back, more than 30 years. It's worth waiting for, too, because there's nothing in life quite like the big leagues."

On the Jewish angle, he said, "They said I was the Jewish ballplayer John McGraw always wanted. But McGraw was primarily interested in good ballplayers, although I know he felt that a Jewish one wouldn't do any harm at the gate."

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